

DIGITAL MARKETING FINAL PROJECT



Marketing Strategy Analysis & Global Growth Campaign

Colton Gillingham · Alex Sanchez



Two Parts, One Playbook

This report first breaks down what the NBA has already done from a marketing perspective, then proposes a digital campaign to build on it.



Current Marketing Strategy

Communications, channels, messaging, and target market over the past 6 months



Campaign Proposal: NBA World Tour

Objectives, channels, execution plan, metrics, and timeline for global growth

Why This Report Matters

This report analyzes the NBA's marketing efforts over the past six months and presents a digital marketing strategy designed to expand global reach and improve fan engagement. Together, the two sections highlight the NBA's current success while offering a forward-thinking plan to solidify its status as a global sports leader.

1

Communications

What messaging the NBA used, and why it resonated

2

Channels

Where content lives, and what each platform is for

3

Opportunity

Where the current strategy can grow — and how

I

PART ONE

What the NBA Has Done

A marketing perspective on the league's communications, channels, and messaging over the past six months.

A Six-Month Transition



With the new season now underway, marketing cadence should settle into a more consistent rhythm.

A Platform for Every Kind of Fan

1

IG / TikTok

Short-form, visually engaging content — stat graphics and game highlights. Great for quick engagement with younger fans.

2

X (Twitter)

Live game updates and longer-form storylines and award-race debate, built for real-time engagement.

3

YouTube

Long-form content — recaps, podcasts, player interviews — for fans who want a deeper connection.

4

Website / App

Live games, exclusive content, and a historic archive dating back to the 1960s, for the most loyal fans.

5

Snapchat

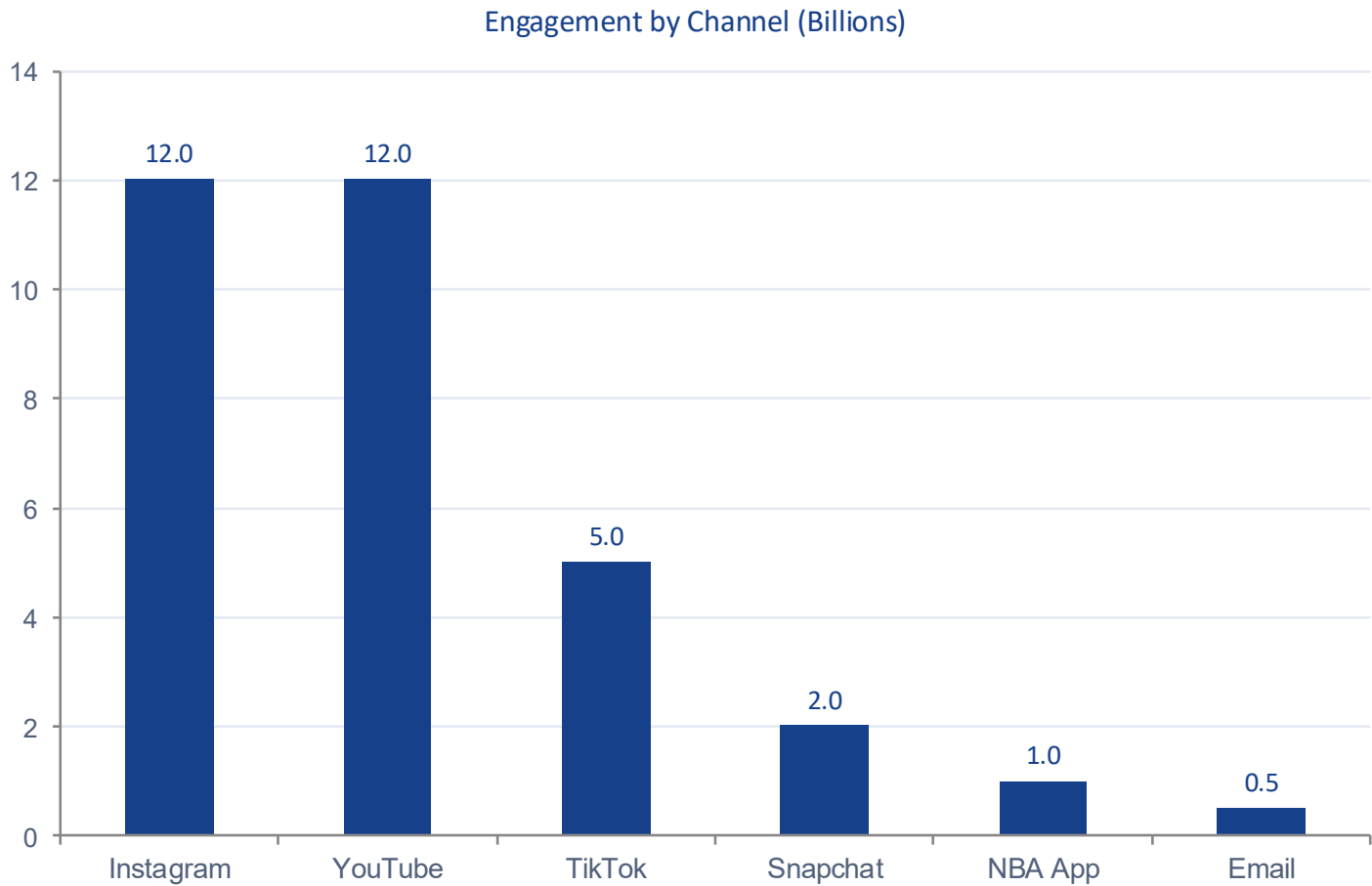
A smaller-scale channel, best suited to niche campaigns and deeper, app-based fan engagement.

6

Email

Primarily informational — built to inform and retain existing subscribers rather than win new fans.

Where Engagement Actually Lives



Source: NBA Marketing Channels — Engagement and Followers Comparison (internal report analysis)

TOP TWO CHANNELS

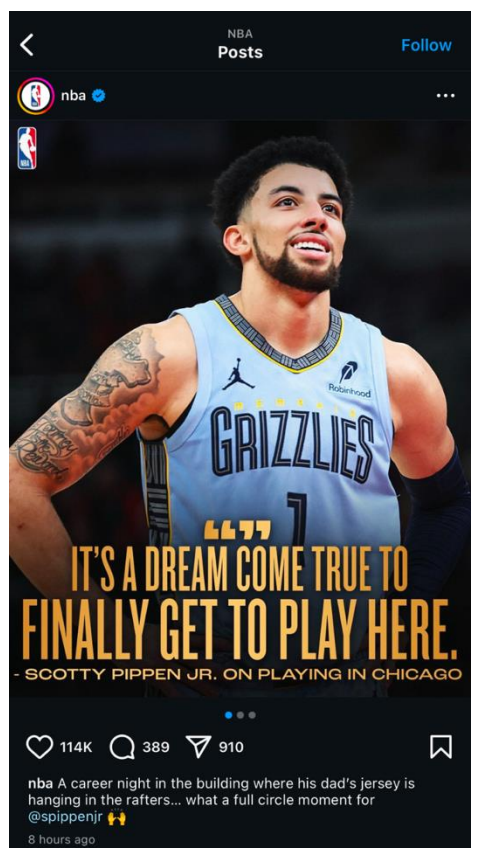
Instagram & YouTube

12B engagement each — the clear leaders for visibility and audience interaction.

TikTok is the one to watch: 5B engagement and 30M followers, with real upside for reaching younger demographics through viral, short-form content.

Snapchat, the NBA App, and Email trail in volume but remain useful for niche campaigns and personalized, loyal-fan communication.

Content in Action



Instagram Post

Player-first storytelling — a quote-driven post celebrating a full-circle career moment.



Instagram Story

"NBA Cup Explained" — using stories to break down league formats for casual fans.



Instagram Post

Standings, clean and current — informative content built for committed fans tracking the race.

A Global Brand, Not Just a League

The NBA has built part of its content around players' perspectives, not just their play — a storytelling approach that resonates with fans and followers worldwide, and drives real engagement across formats.

1

International Games

Preseason games in Abu Dhabi featuring the Celtics and Nuggets show a real push to grow the global fan base.

2

Creator Partnerships

The Celebrity All-Star Game brings well-known influencers onto the court in front of a full arena.

3

Multi-Platform Reach

A presence on every major platform, each tuned to a specific content style and audience.

4

Room to Grow

More region-specific content — following the NFL and F1 playbook — could meaningfully extend global reach.

Growing New Fans, Keeping Old Ones

WHO THEY'RE REACHING

- Gen Z
- Millennials
- International fans
- Sports enthusiasts

HOW THEY KEEP LEGACY FANS

Consistent content style

New formats are layered on, not swapped in — keeping content familiar to older generations.

Legacy players as announcers

Hiring players fans watched years ago keeps a familiar, trusted voice in the broadcast booth.

II

PART TWO

NBA World Tour

A digital marketing campaign proposal built to expand global reach and deepen fan engagement.

Campaign Theme: NBA World Tour

The NBA's primary audience is still concentrated in the U.S. To expand globally, this campaign focuses on increasing fan engagement and broadening international presence — building on the multi-platform strategy already in place.

- 1 Continue exhibition games worldwide to promote the league and grow team involvement
- 2 Host higher-stakes games overseas — regular-season and in-season tournament matchups, not just preseason
- 3 Build partnerships around events like the Olympics or World Cup, and run local community events where an audience already exists
- 4 Add a new All-Star Weekend event as international talent continues to grow

Two Goals, Clearly Measured

+20%

Increase Fan Engagement

Boost social media interactions by 20% within six months.

+15%

Expand Global Reach

Grow international viewership by 15% in targeted markets over one year.

Campaign Channels

TV

Broadcast exhibition games live, with localized commentary tailored to each target region.

Instagram

Behind-the-scenes content, player-fan interactions, and exhibition highlights — fueled by hashtags and challenges like #NBAWorldTour and #NBAGlobal.

YouTube

Exclusive interviews, game recaps, and fan stories, plus live Q&A sessions that connect players directly with the audience.

Target Markets & Execution Plan

TARGET MARKETS

Countries with growing basketball communities — Philippines, France, and Argentina — while tapping into emerging markets beyond them.

Philippines

France

Argentina

+ emerging markets

1

Exhibition Games

Organize games in major international cities for on-the-ground fan experiences, partnering with local influencers and celebrities for regional impact.

2

Localized Content

Translate key posts into native languages and highlight cultural connections — like local fans' own stories and love for the game.

3

Interactive Campaigns

Launch global challenges such as "Show Your Court" fan videos or virtual meet-and-greet contests.

Metrics Worth Tracking

1

Engagement Rate by Region

Monitor likes, shares, comments, and hashtag participation, broken out by target geography.

2

Website Traffic by Geography

Track the lift in international traffic to the NBA's official website and app.

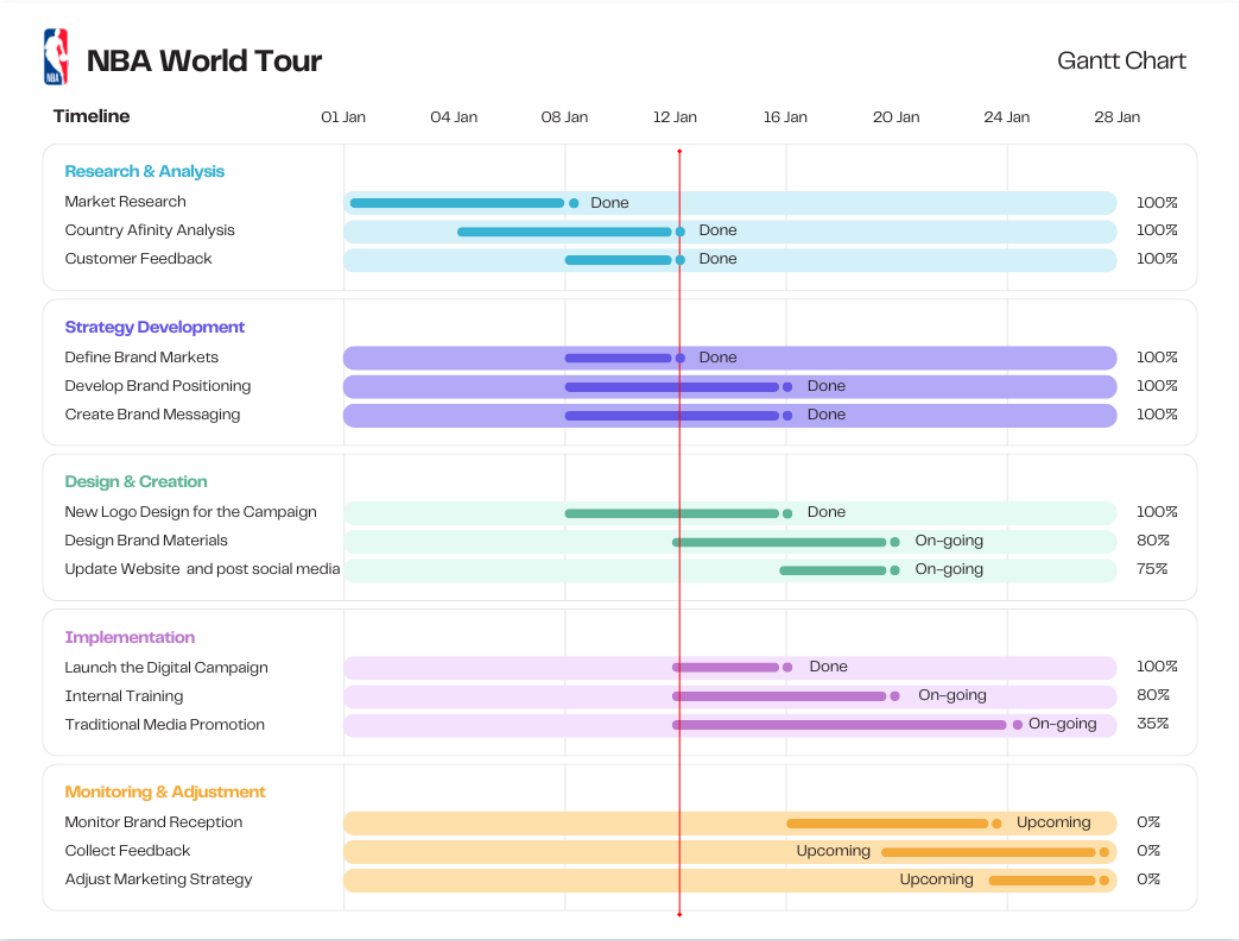
3

Subscriptions by Country

Measure growth in NBA League Pass and regional streaming subscriptions.

Execution Timeline

A four-stage rollout — Research & Analysis, Strategy Development, Design & Creation, and Implementation — followed by ongoing Monitoring & Adjustment.



CONCLUSION

Multimedia, Storytelling, Flexibility

The NBA's marketing shows how digital strategy adapts across seasons — Instagram and TikTok for quick, visual moments; YouTube and podcasts for deeper connection; email for personal retention. Its global push, from Abu Dhabi to Mexico, ties directly into localized digital content that makes the brand feel connected worldwide.

Storytelling wins

Player-first narratives, from all kinds of backgrounds, make content engaging, informative, and globally relatable.

Segmentation sharpens it

A more individualized, geography-based strategy makes marketing feel personal, wherever the fan is.

Data keeps it sharp

Ongoing analytics across Instagram, Google, and beyond let the NBA tweak strategy in real time.

Bibliography

- Chan-Olmsted, S., & Kim, H. J. (2022). Influencer marketing dynamics: The roles of social engagement, trust, and influence.
- Digital Agency Network. (n.d.). Best NBA marketing campaigns & examples: The MVP of marketing. Retrieved December 6, 2024, from digitalagencynetwork.com
- Friend, T. (2024, October 3). NBA unveils new promotional campaign ahead of 2024-25 season. Sports Business Journal. Retrieved from sportsbusinessjournal.com
- Mintz, O. (2023). Metrics for marketing decisions: Drivers and implications for performance. Performance Drivers, 15(1). NIM Marketing Intelligence Review.